GST Law Corpus — Project Status Report

A single, searchable, official-source database of Indian GST law, built from government sources only.

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Status:	Working corpus, in active expansion

1. Purpose and scope

The objective is a single reference database of Indian GST law that can be searched in one place — the Central and State GST Acts and Rules, notifications, circulars, advance rulings, and tribunal decisions — assembled exclusively from official government publications.

The intended use is research and reference: locating the exact provision, notification or ruling that governs a question, and following a citation back to the official document it came from. The corpus is a research tool. It is not legal advice, and every entry links to its original government source so that the source remains authoritative.

2. Progress at a glance

13,126
documents held

163 / 163
CGST Rules, full text

2,888
advance rulings

1,085
HSN / SAC rate codes

Measure	Count
Documents in the corpus database	10,238
Documents with full extracted text	10,087 (99%)
Documents searchable by keyword	10,087 (100% of text)
Central Acts, Rules and sections	3,164
… CGST Rules 2017 held in full	163 of 163 rules
… central Act sections with wording	702 of 769
Advance rulings (AAR / AAAR)	2,888
HSN / SAC rate codes mapped to a rate	1,085
Total documents across all layers	**13,126**

Figures exclude 992 rows that were found to repeat another document's text — where a State publishes one consolidated order covering many notifications, the corpus now holds that order once and records the other notifications as references to it, rather than counting the same text repeatedly.

3. What the corpus contains

The three layers below are the ones the department identified as carrying the value. They are listed first, and the rest of the corpus follows.

Layer	Documents	Text
Central GST Acts, Rules and sections	3,164	CGST Rules complete; 702 of 769 Act sections worded
Advance rulings (AAR / AAAR)	2,888	Complete
GST Council minutes and discussion papers	59	Complete
Central notifications and circulars	476	99%
Judgments and tribunal notices	114	Complete
State GST Acts	75	All 28 states, full act text
State GST notifications (secondary)	6,350	98%

Central GST Rules, 2017

All 163 CGST Rules are now held with their full wording, taken from the CBIC's own consolidated rules document — the single authoritative text of the Rules as amended. This is the layer most often reached for in practice, covering registration, input tax credit, tax invoices, refunds, e-way bills and the assessment and appeals machinery, and it was previously held as structure only, with no wording at all.

Central Act sections now stand at 702 of 769 carrying their wording. The 67 outstanding are mostly the 2023 amendment Acts, which the official repository does not carry at section level.

State coverage (secondary)

On the department's guidance, state notifications are treated as a secondary layer: a State's notifications largely reproduce the Centre's, so the marginal value of further scraping there is low. The coverage below is therefore reported for completeness rather than as the measure of the corpus. It is the *central* layers — Acts, Rules, rulings and Council minutes — that carry the value, and those are the ones being finished.

Material is nonetheless held for **31 of the 36 states and union territories**, in two distinct ways:

Basis	States / UTs	What it means
Dedicated state feed	15	Harvested from the state's own portal — the freshest source
India Code	14	Held from the official India Code repository; no dedicated feed yet
Portal blocked	2	West Bengal and Bihar — material held, portal unreachable
Nothing yet	6	Union territories that administer GST through central legislation

This round added **1,173 State GST notifications** for eight states that previously had none — Jharkhand, Madhya Pradesh, Tripura, Arunachal Pradesh, Uttarakhand, Chandigarh, Mizoram and Meghalaya — taken

from India Code. Each carries the notification's own text, and each is recorded against its state, so a search can be limited to a single state's notifications.

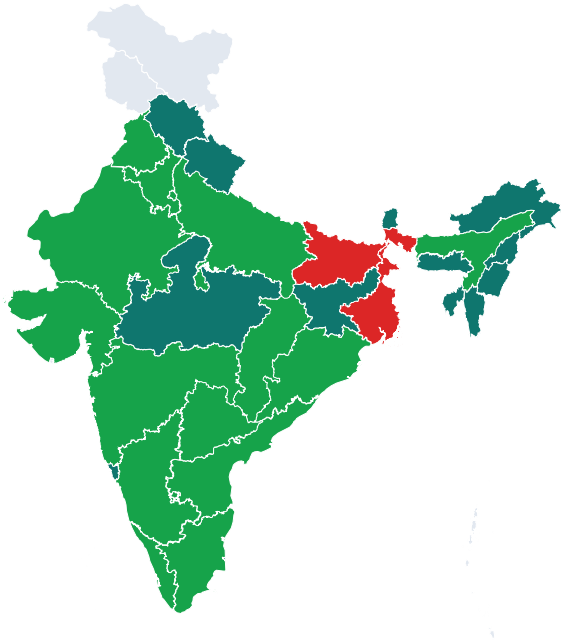
State GST Acts

Every one of the 28 states now has its State Goods and Services Tax Act held in full — about 7 MB of statute text that was previously absent entirely. These come from the official India Code repository, which carries each state's Act with the text already extracted, and each one retains the link to its own source. Three union territories are also covered; the remainder administer GST through central legislation or a neighbouring state's Act.

Rate reference (HSN / SAC)

A structured rate reference is held: **1,821 published rate lines** covering **1,085 commodity and service codes**, taken from the CBIC rate schedule. Each line records the schedule, the code, the description and the CGST, SGST/UTGST, IGST and compensation-cess rate, so a question of the form "what is the rate on this code" can be answered directly rather than by reading through a notification. Entries the department has withdrawn are preserved and marked, so a code that no longer applies is distinguishable from one never listed.

Coverage by state and union territory



- Own feed — 15 states/UTs
- Via India Code — 14 states/UTs
- Blocked — 2 states/UTs
- Not yet covered — 5 states/UTs

Material is held for 31 of India's 36 states and union territories — 15 harvested from the state's own portal, 14 held through the official India Code repository, and 2 where the portal is unreachable but material is held.

A state's own portal is the fresher source, so the India Code states are *covered* rather than *complete* — that distinction is the next piece of work, and it is why the two are coloured separately.

Not yet covered (5): Andaman & Nicobar Islands, Dadra & Nagar Haveli and Daman & Diu, Jammu & Kashmir, Ladakh, Lakshadweep — union territories that administer GST through central legislation or a neighbouring state's Act.

State / UT	Docs	Basis
Telangana	1,191	Own feed
Maharashtra	761	Own feed
Andhra Pradesh	704	Own feed
Odisha	613	Own feed
Rajasthan	588	Own feed
Gujarat	566	Own feed
Jharkhand	534	Via India Code
Delhi	476	Own feed
Uttar Pradesh	432	Own feed
Madhya Pradesh	415	Via India Code
West Bengal	414	Blocked
Tripura	188	Via India Code
Assam	80	Own feed
Tamil Nadu	70	Own feed
Arunachal Pradesh	69	Via India Code
Karnataka	56	Own feed

State / UT	Docs	Basis
Chhattisgarh	42	Own feed
Haryana	40	Own feed
Kerala	21	Own feed
Mizoram	19	Via India Code
Punjab	15	Own feed
Nagaland	12	Via India Code
Bihar	8	Blocked
Chandigarh	6	Via India Code
Uttarakhand	5	Via India Code
Meghalaya	3	Via India Code
Manipur	3	Via India Code
Goa	1	Via India Code
Himachal Pradesh	1	Via India Code
Puducherry	1	Via India Code
Sikkim	1	Via India Code

4. Source assurance and compliance

- **Government sources only.** Every record traces to a court, tribunal, legislature or government department publishing on a `.gov.in` or `.nic.in` host. No commercial law reporter and no third-party aggregator material is used.
- **Provenance retained.** Each record stores the publisher's own URL, so any entry can be traced back to the official document it came from.
- **Attribution.** Sources are acknowledged as their terms require; the corpus is published on attribution terms rather than as public domain.
- **Statutory exclusions applied.** Material that a statute or a court direction bars from publication is excluded — victim and child identity in sexual-offence and juvenile matters, and any order reciting an in-camera or non-publication direction.
- **Snapshots are dated.** The corpus records the position as at the date of collection and is not a live feed; each entry should be verified against the official source before being relied on.

5. What is next

Following the department's steer, effort is concentrated on the central layers. State notification scraping is no longer a priority.

1. **Finish the central Act section wording.** 67 of 769 sections remain — mostly the 2023 amendment Acts, which the official repository does not carry at section level. These will need to come from the amending Acts themselves.
2. **Deepen the advance-ruling layer.** The rulings are held and indexed; work continues on extracting, for each ruling, the question asked and the rate or position decided, so rulings can be searched by subject rather than by text.
3. **Extend the Council minutes.** Fifty-nine minutes and discussion papers are held. These are the record of the Council's own reasoning on rate and procedural changes, and are worth completing.
4. **Resolve the remaining access restrictions.** Two forums — the GST Appellate Tribunal and the Supreme Court judgment service — require interactive verification that we have not automated.
5. **Ongoing refresh.** A periodic check for new notifications, rule amendments, rate changes and rulings, so the corpus does not go stale between editions.

6. Where we would welcome your guidance

The following are the points where your knowledge of the department's own systems would materially speed this up. Each is a question we cannot answer reliably from outside the department.

1. Confirm the official notification portal for the twelve uncovered states

We want to be certain we collect from the correct, current official source for each of Arunachal Pradesh, Goa, Himachal Pradesh, Jharkhand, Madhya Pradesh, Manipur, Meghalaya, Mizoram, Nagaland, Sikkim, Tripura and Uttarakhand. Some state portals have recently been redesigned or moved.

Why it helps: it prevents us collecting from a superseded site and guarantees the corpus reflects the department's own published record.

2. Verify the State GST Acts we have collected

We now hold a State GST Act for each of the 28 states, taken from the official India Code repository. We would be grateful for confirmation that this list is complete and current, and in particular whether any state has amended or re-enacted its Act in a way that supersedes the version we hold.

Why it helps: we are relying on the repository's own titles to identify each Act, and India Code's titles carry occasional errors — one state's Act is listed with "Gooda" for "Goods". A departmental list would settle it.

3. Advise on the authoritative basis for HSN / SAC rates

For the rate reference we intend to work from the rate notifications. We would welcome your confirmation that this is the correct basis, or a pointer to the official rate schedule the department regards as authoritative.

Why it helps: the rate reference is the part of the corpus most likely to be relied on directly, so its basis matters most.

4. Guidance on access to the GST Appellate Tribunal and Supreme Court records

Both portals require an interactive verification step that we have not automated, so coverage of these two sources is currently minimal. If an official bulk or registered access route exists, we would be glad to use it.

Why it helps: tribunal and Supreme Court decisions are the most significant part of the corpus we cannot currently reach.

5. A spot-check of sample records

We would welcome a review of a sample of records by your team — section numbers, notification references, and in-force / repealed status. Any error found can be corrected and traced to its source.

Why it helps: correctness on a sample is the strongest assurance we can offer on the corpus as a whole.

6. Confirm whether any categories should be excluded or prioritised

If there are categories of document that should not be included, or that matter more than others for your use, we can adjust the scope accordingly.

7. Limitations to note

- **Not legal advice.** The corpus is a research aid. It does not replace the official text of any provision.
- **Point-in-time.** Each layer reflects the position as at its date of collection. Legislation changes and orders are appealed; entries should be verified against the official source.
- **Coverage is not yet complete.** State GST *Acts* are held for all 28 states and material is held for 31 of 36 states and territories, but only 15 are harvested from the state's own portal; the rest come from the India Code repository and may lag the state's own feed.
- **Section wording.** The wording is held for 702 of the 769 central sections; the remainder are mostly the 2023 amendment Acts.
- **Rate reference.** The rate reference reflects the CBIC schedule as published. Rates change by notification, so it carries the same point-in-time caveat as the rest of the corpus.

Prepared 14 September 2026. All figures measured directly from the corpus database on that date.